🛠 STAR CITIZEN · SALVAGE · GEAR, TECHNIQUE & HOTSPOTS

SC Salvage Guide

Equipment in detail and how to use it — plus the best wreck hotspots. Three streams: RMC, construction materials and components/cargo.

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STREAMS	SOLO SHIP	BUFFER	TOP VALUE
RMC · CMat · parts	**Drake Vulture**	**~13 SCU**	**CMat**

PATCH
4.9–4.10

01 The salvage loop & three streams

No green window — clean, overlapping passes.

1 · HULL SCRAPING → RMC

Scrape the hull

Scrape the outer coating → **RMC**. Packs **straight into SCU crates**, no refining. Main income.

2 · STRUCTURAL → CMAT

Disintegrate frame

Break the bare frame → raw **construction rubble/pieces/salvage** → refine at a station into **construction materials**. Currently top value.

3 · COMPONENTS / CARGO

Recover

Tractor out components, weapons, crates → sell or reuse. Bonus profit.

🎮 Controls

MODE	KEY (DEFAULT)	PURPOSE
Salvage mode on/off	`M`	Salvage HUD & arms
Switch head	`RMB`	cycle salvage heads
Scrape / disintegrate	`LMB`	strip hull / dissolve frame
Focus narrow/wide	`wheel`	beam width (coverage ↔ precision)

TECHNIQUE

No green window like mining — the skill is **clean, overlapping passes** across the whole surface without leaving material. Buffer full → the ship forms an SCU crate; only scrape on after ejecting it.

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02 Equipment & usage

🚀 Ships

SHIP	ROLE	STRUCTURAL OUTPUT
Drake Vulture	Solo, ~13 SCU buffer — best entry	Construction **Rubble**
Argo MOTH	mid-tier (more throughput)	Construction **Pieces**
Aegis Reclaimer	crew, huge throughput + component recovery	Construction **Salvage** (highest grade)

NEW (4.9/4.10): CMAT NEEDS REFINING

Structural salvage comes out **raw** (rubble/pieces/salvage) and must be **refined into construction materials at a station** before it's worth selling. Higher grade (Reclaimer > MOTH > Vulture) = more material per unit. **RMC** still packs straight into SCU crates (no refining).

RAW OUTPUT	SHIP	GRADE → CMAT YIELD
Construction Rubble	Drake Vulture	lowest
Construction Pieces	Argo MOTH	medium
Construction Salvage	Aegis Reclaimer	highest

RUBBLE VS. PIECES VS. SALVAGE

These are **not different materials** but **grade tiers of the same structural raw** — which one you get depends on the ship. All three refine at a station into **construction materials**; higher grade = more CMat per unit. ⚠ **Important:** some **contracts demand exactly one type** (e.g. "deliver X construction rubble"/"...pieces"/"...salvage") — then you need the **matching ship** (rubble = Vulture, pieces = MOTH, salvage = Reclaimer). Read the contract first!

🔧 Salvage heads & hand tools

HEAD	CHARACTER	FOR
Cambio-Lite SRT (default)	balanced, stock	all-rounder, good start
Abrade	wide, fast area scraping	big hulls efficiently
Cinch	focused, low waste	precise, max yield

HEAD	CHARACTER	FOR
Trawler	throughput-oriented	experienced salvagers

MUST-HAVE HAND TOOLS

Tractor beam (TruHold/MaxLift) — the biggest efficiency upgrade: pull SCU crates onto the cargo grid & recover components. Plus a **multi-tool with a salvage attachment** (Cambio-Lite SRT / Pyro RYT) for hand-scraping small spots. **Loadouts:** beginner = 2× Cambio-Lite SRT · throughput = Abrade + Trawler · high-yield = Cinch.

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03 Materials & selling

CMat currently beats RMC — take both streams.

MATERIAL	SOURCE	≈ AUEC/SCU	BEST SPOT (VARIES)
Construction Materials TOP	structural (refined)	~12,000–15,000	ARC-L4 Faint Glen
RMC	Hull Scraping	~7,000–8,500	Seer's Canyon
Scrap	rough scrap	~3,400–4,600	Rod's Fuel 'N Supplies
Components / Cargo	recovery	variable	TDD / own use

SELLING STRATEGY

Sell RMC & CMat at the **TDD in the big cities** (usually better than scrapyards). Given prices, **CMat first**. Check current top spots live (UEX/Star-Head) — prices swing daily, RMC was recently devalued.

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04 Where to salvage? (wreck hotspots)

Stanton (safe standard)

SPOT	WHAT	NOTE
CRU-L1	UEE patrol wrecks	reliable, lots of supply
HUR-L2 (Everus)	MOLE/Prospector wrecks, abandoned stations	high-density industrial composite
ARC-L3 (Baijini)	transport & security wrecks	commercial scrap
Javelin wrecks	huge, multi-day	group-friendly

SPOT	WHAT	NOTE
Scrapyards	buy-in (+ wrecks nearby)	Brio's (Daymar) · Samson & Son's (Wala) · Reclamation Orinth (Hurston) · Devlin (Euterpe)

🔥 Pyro (lawless, wreck-rich)

Constant PvP → **fresh wrecks** at outlaw stations (Ruin Station, Checkmate, Orbituary, Rat's Nest) & contested zones, plus the **Adagio 100k contracts** (big hulls C2/M2/A2, 890 Jump = lots of RMC). High reward, high risk — selling can be buggy → often haul back to Stanton / Grim Hex.

❄ Nyx — Glaciem Ring (quiet)

Littered with **derelicts** (abandoned breaker stations, old QV facilities) → ideal for quiet **panel salvage** away from PvP. Downside: long trips, limited selling → plan the haul back to Stanton.

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05 Contracts & reputation

- **Salvage contracts** in the Contract Manager (mobiGlas): verified (less risk, steady) vs. unverified (more risk, bigger reward). Flow: possible fee → marked wreck → salvage → profit + reputation.
- **Adagio Holdings:** as Senior Contractor you unlock the **100k salvage contracts** — often big hulls with lots of RMC (frequently lead to Pyro).
- 🆕 **4.9 — Recco Battaglia "Ship in Distress" (Nyx/Levski):** clear a Caterpillar → repair the power plant → get paid → then salvage the Caterpillar & Cutlass. One mission = aUEC + reputation + loot + CMat.

> TOP TIPS & PITFALLS
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> ✅ Overlapping passes (miss nothing) · ✅ tractor multi-tool always · ✅ both streams (CMat tops) · ✅ **sell often** — the Vulture is defenceless. ❌ don't treat scrapyards as "safe" (outlaw-adjacent) · ❌ don't do RMC only. Solo rule of thumb: ~180,000–300,000 aUEC/h.

↗ Sources

Prices/spawns patch-dependent — verify live.

Star Citizen Wiki — Salvage ↗

UEX Corp — RMC/CMat prices & best sell locations ↗

Salvage Material Finder (4.10) ↗

Based on: own SC_Vulture_Salvage_Guide.pdf (4.8.3) + 4.9/4.10 updates. Unofficial, not affiliated with CIG. Star Citizen® is a trademark of CIG. All data without warranty.